

VeriCase – Onboarding Wireframe v0.2

Purpose

Provide a minimal, developer ready wireframe for the initial access and setup experience based on your instructions. Focus is limited to login, invitations, setup wizard, and the two configuration dashboards for Case and Project.

Status

Draft for review. Scope is only the onboarding flow and first configuration screens.

1. Entry and Authentication

Screen 1A. Access email for Team Leader • Sender: VeriCase no reply • Subject: Your access to VeriCase • Body elements: short intro, one time access button, support link • Actions: Open VeriCase, Copy access link

Screen 1B. Sign in page • Fields: email, one time code field appears after submission • Actions: Send code, Resend code, Use magic link instead • State notes: rate limit after multiple attempts, show locked state banner if required

Screen 1C. First time welcome • Message: Welcome, you are the Team Leader for Organisation name • Primary action: Start setup wizard • Secondary actions: Invite team, Explore later

2. Setup Wizard hub

Screen 2A. Choose what to set up first • Three large cards with short descriptions

1. Set up team
2. Create your first Case
3. Create your first Project • Footer: You can return here any time from the header menu
4. Team setup path

Screen 3A. Add people • Input modes • Paste emails multi line with validation • Upload CSV with columns email, name, role optional • Manual add single line • Role selector per row • Team Leader default uneditable for current user • Senior Lawyer, Claims Consultant, QS, Project Manager, External Counsel, Client Viewer • Actions: Add N people, Continue

Screen 3B. Default permissions • Toggle grid per role for core modules Claims, Evidence, Submissions, Matters • Presets: Conservative, Standard, Open • Actions: Apply preset, Continue

Screen 3C. Review and send invitations • List of invitees with status pending validation • Optional message text box • Actions: Send invitations now, Save without sending • Result state: Invitations sent banner showing N sent, M failed with retry option

Screen 3D. Confirmation • Summary: Team created, invitations sent • Next steps: Assign people to Cases and Projects at any time • Primary action: Return to Wizard hub

4. Case setup path

Screen 4A. Case configuration dashboard overview • Two columns • Left: Mandatory items list with progress ticks • Right: Optional items list collapsed groups • Progress bar top right

Mandatory items list

1. Case title
2. Client organisation
3. Our role party role selector Contractor, Employer, Subcontractor
4. Contract form selector JCT, NEC with edition selector
5. Jurisdiction and dispute venue drop downs
6. Key dates basic start and current status date

Optional items list grouped • Parties add opposing and third parties with contacts • Programme baseline upload file or link to scheduling source • Email intake connect mailbox or upload PST EML ZIP • Evidence taxonomy choose default tags now or later • Heads of claim template select template pack JCT or NEC flavour • Access controls assign team to case with roles • Numbering and naming choose prefix and numbering scheme

Screen 4B. Case header editor • Fields: title, reference, client, role, contract form, edition, jurisdiction, venue • Save and continue

Screen 4C. Parties • Table: Party name, Role, Primary contact, Email • Add party modal

Screen 4D. Programme baseline • Upload area and optional description • Validation: supported types MPP, XER, XML, CSV

Screen 4E. Email intake • Options: Connect Microsoft 365 with consent, or Upload archive • Status panel: connection pending, last sync

Screen 4F. Evidence taxonomy • Multi select default tags and ability to add custom tags

Screen 4G. Heads of claim template • Radio list of templates with preview link • Action: Apply template to this case

Screen 4H. Access controls • Assign people from team with role for this case

Screen 4Z. Case setup review • Checklist with green ticks and grey dots for optional items • Actions: Finish setup, Continue adding options • Result state: Case created toast with link to Case Overview

5. Project setup path

Screen 5A. Project configuration dashboard overview • Two columns as per Case with distinct content

Mandatory items list

1. Project title
2. Employer or client
3. Contract form and edition
4. Site address and region
5. Start and planned completion dates

Optional items list grouped • Team assignment project roles Supervisor, PM, QS, Commercial Lead • Baseline schedule upload or link as with Case • Tender allowances import BoQ CSV or XLSX mapping wizard • Cost code structure choose template or import • Communication channels set up intake email and Teams channel webhooks later optional • Risk register initial risks add or import • Access controls as with Case

Screen 5B. Project header editor • Fields: title, reference, employer, contract form, edition, address postcode finder, dates

Screen 5C. Tender allowances import wizard • Step 1 upload file • Step 2 map columns item, description, unit, qty, rate, cost code • Step 3 validate and import

Screen 5D. Cost code structure • Choose template SMM7, NRM, Custom • Add or edit codes in a tree view

Screen 5Z. Project setup review • Checklist and actions as per Case

6. Wizard behaviour and navigation

General rules • The hub is always accessible from the header Setup button • Each path shows a persistent progress bar • Save and exit is available on every screen • Validation is inline with clear error messages • Keyboard navigation supports Enter to continue and Escape to cancel modal

Edge cases • If no team is added, later assignment is still possible from the Case or Project access control step • If invitations are not sent, the app shows an alert on the dashboard with a resend link

7. Minimal UI components and states

Primary buttons • Continue, Save, Finish setup Secondary buttons • Back, Skip for now, Save as draft Links • Learn more opens side panel, Not now returns to hub Empty states • No team members yet, No cases yet, No projects yet with CTA buttons Toasts and banners • Invitations sent, Setup complete, Connection failed with retry

8. Developer notes

Routing • Public auth routes for sign in and magic link • Private routes for wizard hub and each path Team, Case, Project

Data capture minimal models for onboarding • Organisation, User, Invite, Case, Project, Party, Connection

Analytics and audit minimal • Track step views and completions, store audit entries for invitations and creations

9. Open questions for William

10. Do you want a fourth card on the hub to Import an existing matter from a template or CSV

11. For Case mandatory items, include Contract reference number as a required field or keep optional

12. For Project mandatory items, do you want Employer address to be mandatory

13. Preferred default roles matrix Conservative, Standard, Open details to be defined in a later pass

PST Ingestion & Email Threads — Message-Level Extraction (v1)

Objective Ensure every individual email message is extracted and addressable as its own evidence item while preserving the conversational thread for context, performance, auditability, and export.

A. Data Model (Email Message vs. Thread)

EmailMessage (atom)

- message_uid (stable GUID; from Message-ID or SHA256 of headers+body if absent)
- thread_uid (foreign key)
- parent_uid (from In-Reply-To/References; null for root)

- sent_at_utc (normalised to UTC; source timezone stored)
- from, to[], cc[], bcc[] (bcc retained but masked by permission)
- subject_original, subject_normalised (strip RE/FW)
- body_text, body_html, body_hash
- quoted_segments (byte/char ranges of quoted history detected)
- authored_segment_hash (hash of non-quoted body to power de-dup)
- attachments[] (FK to File; inline vs regular)
- custodian (mailbox owner)
- source_path (PST/EML path; folder)
- headers_raw (preserved RFC822)
- legal_hold (bool)
- Tags (array), Issue codes (array), Linked Claims (array of IDs), Linked Programme Activities (array)
- Audit fields: created_by, created_at, updated_by, updated_at

EmailThread (context)

- thread_uid
- root_uid
- canonical_subject
- participants[] (unique addresses/domains)
- message_count
- date_span (first/last)

B. Ingestion & Extraction Pipeline

1. **Parse** PST/EML → enumerate RFC5322 messages.
2. **Normalise** headers (addresses, casing, encodings, timezones).
3. **Threading**
 - Primary: link via Message-ID + In-Reply-To/References.
 - Secondary heuristics when headers are missing: subject_normalised + participants overlap + ±48h window.
4. **Quoted Text Detection**

- Heuristic and ML signals (prefix markers >, reply separators, “On ... wrote”, HTML blockquotes).
- Persist quoted_segments; compute authored_segment by subtracting quoted.

5. De-duplication

- Near-duplicate collapse on authored_segment_hash within same thread.
- Signature/footer normalisation (strip standard banners, disclaimers before hashing).

6. Attachments Handling

- Extract each attachment as its own File record; link back to EmailMessage.
- Run OCR/indexing for PDFs/images.

7. Indexing

- Send fields to search index (OpenSearch/ES): subject, body_text, authored_segment, participants, dates, tags, claims, programme links.

8. Integrity

- Store raw EML blob per message; compute SHA256; retain headers for chain-of-custody.

C. Permissions & Audit

- **BCC governance:** BCC visible only to custodians/admin; masked for others; permissioned queries exclude BCC by default.
- **Message-level audit:** every tag/edit/link recorded with before/after.
- **Thread-level actions:** log bulk operations (e.g., “applied tag X to 17 messages”).

D. User Experience (Message-Level, Thread-Aware)

1. Evidence Inbox View

- Left panel: results list (messages, not threads) with chips: Tag, Has attachments, Custodian, Date.
- Toggle: “Group by Thread” (collapses to thread rows with message count badges).

2. Thread View Drawer

- Centre panel shows **one selected message**.

- Top timeline of thread with nodes per message; click to jump.
- Quoted text is folded by default with “Show quoted history”.

3. Tagging Controls

- Apply tag to **this message** or **entire thread** (explicit checkbox).
- Inherit/propagate option: apply to this and **all downstream replies**.

4. Linking Controls

- Link selected message to Claim(s) and Programme Activity(ies).
- Thread map shows which messages are already linked (tick marks on nodes).

5. Search & Filters

- Default unit = **message**. Advanced filter thread:UID or “Group by Thread”.
- Facets: Participant, Custodian, Date, Has Attachment, Tag, Issue Code, Linked Claim yes/no, Programme Activity yes/no.

6. Diff & De-dup Assistance

- “Show differences vs previous in thread” to highlight new authored text.
- “Hide repeated quoted history” toggle to reduce noise.

E. Exports & Bundles (Defensible)

- Export selection can be **message-level** or **thread-level**.
- PDF bundle options:
 - Include headers page (From/To/CC/BCC*, Date, Message-ID, Hash).
 - Include/exclude quoted history.
 - Preserve inline images/attachments (embedded or as exhibits with cross-refs).
- Bates numbering at **message** and **attachment** granularity.
- Always include SHA256 and source path in export manifest.

F. Performance at 1M+ Messages

- Index authored segments separately for faster, more relevant search.
- Pre-compute thread timelines; lazy-load message bodies on demand.
- Capped result windows with infinite scroll; server-side sorting and pagination.

- Background jobs for OCR and de-dup with progress meters.

G. Edge Cases & Handling Rules

- Missing Message-ID: generate deterministic ID (hash of normalised headers+body).
- Timezone anomalies: preserve source offset; display in user locale with hover for original.
- Forwards with edited subjects: rely on references where present; else heuristics.
- Read receipts, meeting invites, auto-replies: classify and allow filter to exclude.
- Shared attachments across messages: de-duplicate by file hash; show “used in N messages”.

H. Accuracy & Chain-of-Custody

- Preserve raw message EML and compute cryptographic hash at ingest.
- Immutable store for originals; edits never mutate raw.
- Full audit export (CSV/JSON) for who, when, what changed at message/tag/link level.

Outcome

- Review volume is reduced to **unique authored messages**.
- Users can act at **message granularity** while keeping thread context.
- Exports are legally robust and reproducible.

Message Visibility & Chronology UX Spec (v1)

Objective Prevent the message table from becoming unreadable at scale while preserving message-level granularity and precise chronology across multiple concurrent threads on the same topic.

1) Core Principles

- **Message-first, thread-aware:** unit of review is the *message*, with a lightweight thread mini-map for context.
- **High information density, low cognitive load:** compact rows with critical metadata and a single-line authored excerpt.

- **Time fidelity:** everything is ordered by sent_at_utc with stable tie-breaks; cross-thread chronology is one click away.
- **Progressive disclosure:** show only what helps triage; full details live in the preview drawer.

2) Table Layout (Compact Results Grid)

Columns (left→right)

1. Select checkbox
2. Importance chip (Unread, Flagged, Pinned) – optional
3. Sent At (localised; tooltip shows original source timezone)
4. From → To (compact list; +N overflow badge)
5. Subject (normalised; RE/FW stripped; ellipsis)
6. Excerpt (first 140 chars of **authored segment**; quoted text excluded)
7. Attach (paperclip + count)
8. Tags (max 2 shown; +N overflow)
9. Linked (Claim/Event icons with counts)
10. Thread (mini-map: tiny sparkline with node count; current node highlighted)

Row behaviour

- Hover reveals quick actions: Preview, Open in Thread, Tag, Link, More (⋮).
- Row height 40–44 px; no wrapping except excerpt.
- Infinite scroll with virtualised rendering.

3) Thread Mini-Map (Per-Row Context)

- Tiny horizontal series of dots; the selected message is bold; colours indicate sender changes.
- Click to open full Thread Timeline in the preview drawer at the correct node.

4) Preview Drawer (Right Panel)

- Header: From/To/Cc/Bcc (permissioned), Sent At (local + original offset), Subject; per-message permalink.
- Body: render **authored segment first**, quoted history collapsed; “Show quoted” toggles.

- Diff tab: *New vs previous in thread* highlight to surface what changed.
- Related tab: suggested similar messages across threads.
- Actions: Tag, Link to Claim/Event, Add Note, Pin.

5) Cross-Thread Chronology (“Chronology Lens”)

- Toolbar button: **Open Chronology Lens**.
- Merges all selected messages (from multiple threads) into one **time-ordered strip**.
- Left rail lists **participants** with colour tracks; hovering a participant highlights their messages.
- Controls: filter by participant, time window, has attachments, tag(s).
- Use-case: three separate threads on the same matter can be viewed as a single sequence to pinpoint *what X said at 14:03 vs 14:21 elsewhere*.

6) Topic Grouping without Losing Message Granularity

- Optional *Topic* tag (auto-suggested by ML; user-editable) allows grouping disparate threads.
- In table: toggle **Group by Topic** collapses rows into Topic buckets ordered by most recent activity; within each, messages remain chronologically listed.

7) Precision Filters for Triage

- Quick filters bar: **Untagged**, **Has attachments**, **My participants**, **Pinned**, **Within window** (date picker), **Only authored deltas** (excludes messages where authored segment is empty or trivial).
- Saved searches persist these combinations.

8) Pivotal Message Controls

- **Pin**: elevates a message; pinned items float to top within current filter and appear in a left-nav “Pins” view.
- **Star participants**: highlight rows authored by starred people.
- **Notes/Annotations**: inline note icon on rows; hover to preview.

9) Keyboard & Power-User Flow

- ↑/↓ to move selection; Space to open Preview; Enter to open Thread; t to Tag; l to Link; p to Pin.
- / focuses search; f opens filters; s saves search.

10) Performance & Stability

- Server-side sorting by sent_at_utc then message_uid; index on (case_id, sent_at_utc, participants, tags).
- Result windows capped; virtualised list; prefetch next page.
- Preview lazy-loads HTML; sanitised rendering.

11) Accessibility

- WCAG AA: keyboard focus states; ARIA roles for grid and drawer; colour-safe indicators.
- Provide text equivalents for mini-map (e.g. “Message 4 of 12 in thread”).

12) Export/Share from Views

- Export current filtered set (CSV/PDF bundle). Options: include quoted history, include notes, include audit manifest.
- Shareable saved search link (permission-aware).

Outcome

- The table remains readable and actionable at scale.
- Reviewers can isolate *who said what, exactly when*, even across multiple concurrent threads.
- Chronology Lens provides the decisive visibility advantage for litigation and claims.

UI Operation Map – Where Heads of Claim live and where AI appears (v1)

Goal Give a concrete, screen-by-screen map of how users navigate: where **Heads of Claim** are created/managed, how **messages** and **evidence** are linked, and where the **AI search/assist** surfaces in each module, including **Rebuttal Mode**.

A) Global Frame

- **Top Bar:** Case switcher • Global search (Ctrl+/) • Saved searches • Notifications • Help • User
- **Left Nav:** Dashboard • Matters • **Evidence** • **Claims** • **Rebuttal** • Submissions • Settings

- **Right Rail (Context Panel):** collapsible panel that different modules use to show AI suggestions, related items, and quick actions

B) Evidence Module (default landing after ingest)

Layout

- **Left:** Facet panel (Date, Parties, Tags, Document Type, Has Attachments, Linked Claim, Programme Activity, Status)
- **Centre: Message Table** (compact rows per Message; thread mini-map; authored excerpt)
- **Right Drawer: Preview** with tabs

Right Drawer Tabs

1. **Details:** Headers, body (authored first; quoted collapsed), attachments, tags, links to claims/activities
2. **AI Suggestions:**
 - *Related evidence:* ranked list with message IDs and confidence
 - *Suggested tags:* auto-inferred tags/issue codes
 - *Programme links:* suggested activity/window chips
3. **Notes:** case notes, pins, internal comments
4. **Audit:** tag/link history; hashes; source path

Where AI appears

- In the **Right Drawer → AI Suggestions** tab (sticky, one-click apply).
- In the **Facet panel header** as a smart filter tip: “Narrow to July–Sept 2022? Involve NHBC and LJJ?” (click to apply)
- In the **row hover quick actions:** “Find similar (AI)” opens a side list overlay with top-10 similar messages.

Heads of Claim access from Evidence

- In row actions: **Link → Add to Head of Claim** (search/select or create new head on the fly)
- Chips on row show current Head links; click to open the Claim detail in a new drawer

C) Claims Module (Heads of Claim)

Layout

- **Left: Claims Tree** (Heads → Sub-heads). Each node shows counts (Linked Evidence, Draft points, Status).
- **Centre: Claim Editor**
 - Sections: Summary • Chronology • Liability • Causation • Evidence Table • Draft Points • Status
- **Right Rail: Evidence Finder (AI) + Snippets**

Evidence Finder (AI) – Right Rail

- Search box seeded with the active section context (e.g., Causation + Head tags)
- Tabs: *Filters* • *AI* • *Saved*
- **AI tab** returns a ranked set of messages/attachments with:
 - snippet, timestamp, participants, confidence, programme chip
 - **Add as citation** button → drops a numbered citation into the editor with message ID and permalink

Draft Points (AI Assist)

- Button: **“Propose Points (AI)”**
- Modal shows 3–6 bullet propositions, each **must** include citations (message IDs) and timestamps
- User accepts/edits; accepted points move into **Draft Points** list and can be inserted into Summary/Liability/Causation sections

Where Heads of Claim live

- **Claims Tree** is the canonical place to manage Heads/Sub-heads (create, rename, order)
- **Evidence Table** inside each claim shows all linked messages; filters and sort by sent time, participant, tag

D) Rebuttal Module (Live adjudication)

Use-case: Opponent submission arrives; user wants fast counter-evidence and a draft.

Layout

- **Left: Submission Outline** (the opponent doc segmented into numbered paragraphs/points)

- **Centre: Rebuttal Workspace**
 - Top ribbon: Date window, Participant focus, Programme window chips
 - For the selected opponent paragraph, centre shows its text with key entities highlighted
 - Below: **Suggested Evidence** table (ranked via hybrid search)
- **Right Rail: AI Rebuttal Points**

AI surfaces in Rebuttal

- **Suggested Evidence** table is generated by AI-assisted retrieval (hybrid lexical+vector, programme boosts)
- **AI Rebuttal Points** panel lists numbered counterpoints, each with required citations (message IDs, timestamps)
- Controls: Accept • Edit • Reject • Add to Defence Bundle

Heads of Claim link-back

- From any suggested evidence row, *Link to Head/Sub-head* drop-down allows immediate association
- Rebuttal points can be assigned to a Head so they are re-usable in the claim narrative

Exports

- **Defence Bundle** export creates: opponent paragraph → accepted rebuttal points → cited evidence list with Bates and hashes

E) Global Search & Saved Views

- **Top Bar Global Search** runs across messages and claims (permissioned)
- Results page has two tabs: **Messages** and **Claims**
- Saved searches appear as chips in the top bar and in the left nav under each case

F) Programme References in UI

- When Construction Add-in is active:
 - Programme **chips** appear on evidence rows and in AI panels
 - Filters include **Programme Activity** and **Window**

- In Claims Editor, a right-rail mini-timeline shows the selected activity's planned vs actual dates; evidence dots appear along the timeline

G) Keyboard and Power UX

- Evidence list: ↑/↓ select, Space = Preview, Enter = Open Thread, a = AI Suggestions tab, ; = Add citation
- Claims editor: Ctrl+. = Propose Points (AI), Ctrl+Enter = Insert selected points
- Rebuttal: r = Refresh suggestions, 1–9 = accept/edit/reject point by index

H) Guardrails & Audit

- AI outputs are **readonly suggestions** until accepted
- Every accepted tag/citation/point logs the source message IDs and hashes
- Warnings appear if accepted points are outside the selected programme window or lack required participants

Outcome

- Heads of Claim are always managed in the Claims module (left tree), but are reachable from Evidence and Rebuttal via quick link menus.
- AI is visible but contained: Evidence Finder in Claims, AI Suggestions in Evidence, and AI Rebuttal Points in Rebuttal.
- The user can move from raw message → claim citation → rebuttal export without losing context or auditability.